Electric shaRed mOBility hUbs Trial (ROBUST): Galway workshop 1 follow-up

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Dear ROBUST Galway co-design workshop 1 participants,

Thank you for your inputs at the first ROBUST Co-design workshop last Wednesday evening (23/9), and to the Climate Action Group for hosting us at the Westside Resource Centre.

There was a lot to take in from all of your comments. We will be looking closely at the materials developed in the workshop over the next weeks and months, with an aim to using your insights to improve the trial and better understand how shared electric mobility hubs might succeed here in Ireland or elsewhere.

Initial takeaways

My initial takeaways from your comments are:

- detailed user information about how to use the apps, the system and pricing is especially important, both online and in physical format.
- the return-to-hub (A-to-A) model for the shared e-bikes and e-cargo-bikes might work better if there was a low daily cap (2 Euros was suggested), such that there is no pressure to rush back to the hub.
- availability of vehicles is important, and it was noted that there is only one cargo bike and one electric car at the Westside hub at the moment.

Immediate steps

Information

I've put together a draft short video on the project, and how to use the e-bikes and e-cars. See the QR code to the right (Figure 1). We are working on more (and better) videos at the moment. Please let us know if you have any initial thoughts, and stay tuned for further versions. Also, if you are interested in having a go and making your own videos or other forms of information about the hub please feel free to just go ahead, or drop us a line if you'd like to collaborate or get some help to get started. One of the interesting things about co-design is that everyone can take part if they would like too!

Figure 1: Draft mobility hub video at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hu9jsgi8CVU

Similarly, I've put together an initial draft website, which is accessible via the QR code in Figure 2[1].

This website is hosted on Github (QR code in Figure 3[2]), and uses open source software. This means that you can edit it yourself and send me a 'pull request'. There are further details in the Readme of the github repository, or you can drop me an email or otherwise reach out if you'd like help getting started.

[1] Or at `https://james-reynolds.github.io/ROBUST_Electric_shaRed_mOBility_hUbS_Trial_website/`



Figure 2: Draft mobility hub website, user facing version

[2] Or at `https://github.com/James-Reynolds/ROBUST_Electric_shaRed_mOBility_hUbS_Trial_website`



Figure 3: Draft mobility hub website, Github source code

Pricing changes

Pricing changes have recently been made to the hub. I'll be able to share full information soon, but these changes are already active in the apps.

I'll also reach out to the Trinity College Dublin (TCD) Project Manager (Sarbast Moselm) and see if we can introduce a daily cap as part of the trial.

Free ride offers

There are free ride promotional codes for the e-bikes (#ROBUSTFREE4), and a promotional code for the e-car (#ROBUSTFREE) that are currently active. I have a request in with the TCD Project Manager to provide a leaflet that fully explains the offer terms and conditions, but in the meantime it should be working and the terms and conditions are all in the various apps.

More workshops

Noreen and I are off to Letterkenny and Waterford over the next month or so to run workshops there. But, neither of us is far away, and we'd certainly be interested in coming back to get your further thoughts an insights as the trial progresses.

More generally, I'm happy to come talk or otherwise interact about transport, implementation and policy-making, or pretty much any other related topic, so please let me know if that is of interest.

All the best,

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